

LECTIO DIVINA ON SUNDAY'S GOSPEL

Take some time to pray, reflect and share as we explore the Gospel for the coming Sunday. Every Monday after the 10am Mass in the Emmaus Room, Pennyburn.

GIVE A STUDENTS A TRUE DERRY WELCOME

For many of our students, coming to Derry is their first time away from home. At Foyle International, we are looking for local people who can offer more than just a spare room. A shared meal, a chat at the end of the day, a bit of advice, a laugh around the kitchen table these small everyday moments can make a huge difference to a student settling into life in Derry. You don't need to be a traditional family to host. Singles, couples, families and retirees are all welcome. Call Foyle International on 02871371535.

FOYLE HOSPICE ANNUAL COFFEE MORNING

Saturday, 10th October, from 10am to 1pm, at Day Therapy, Foyle Hospice, 61 Culmore Road. All welcome. Please come along and support your local hospice.

THE CARE FOR CREATION GROUP

'St Francis of Assisi invites us to see nature as a magnificent book in which God speaks to us and grants us a glimpse of his infinite beauty and goodness.' (Pope Francis: LS 12)

VOCATIONS

Are you 18 years or older and thinking or wondering about serving the Church as a priest of the diocese of Derry? There will be an afternoon Talk with time for Prayer, Discussion, Questions & Answers in Derry on Sunday 11 October. For further details please contact Fr Pat O'Hagan at: pgo2111@gmail.com

FAMILY PRAYER BOOK

This Sunday begins psalter week 3.

RISE & SHINE

Brings children and young people with additional needs on a week-long pilgrimage holiday to Lourdes each Easter. 400 young people with additional needs are invited as guests. This trip is free for our guests as our volunteers fundraise for it. Volunteers pay for their own trip. Each of our groups comprise of around 15 volunteer carers and 10 guests. Every single group includes a group leader, a nurse, and carers. We are accompanied by a team of volunteer doctors who provide additional medical support. If you know of anyone who may be interested in being a guest, applications are open however they do close on the 15th October.

- Representative speaking at all masses next weekend -

PADRE PIO PRAYER GROUP

Tuesday 6 October in Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty, starting with Rosary at 6.45pm before Mass, celebration of Mass at 7.15pm, then the priest will bless everyone with a first-class relic of St. Pio, while closing prayers are recited. Everyone welcome.

PRIVACY NOTICE

The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations, and a privacy notice is available on the Parish website or by contacting the Parish Office. Livestream and recordings of Mass and services in our Churches are available online. Please note that the front rows of seats are visible online.

SAFEGUARDING

If you have any concerns about the Safeguarding of Children or vulnerable adults within the Church, please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596500793 or at dlp@derrydiocese.org

PARISH GROUPS & MEETINGS

Monday	After 10am Mass	Lectio Divina	Emmaus Room, Pennyburn
	After 11am Mass	Holy Souls Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh
	1pm – 2.30pm	Legion of Mary	Meeting Room, St Joseph's Church, Galliagh
	7pm – 8.30pm	Carnhill Folk Group	St Brigid's Church, Carnhill
	7pm - 9pm	Woman's Craft Group	Kildare Room, Carnhill
Tuesday	After 11am Mass	Devotion to the Holy Face	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh
	11.30am - 2.30pm	St. Pio's Café	St Pio Centre, Galliagh
	12pm – 1pm	Reflection on Sunday Scriptures	St Pio Centre, Galliagh
	5.00pm – 5.30pm	St Brigid's Junior Choir	St Brigid's Church, Carnhill
	7.30pm - 9.30pm	Living Disciples Prayer Group	St Pio Centre, Galliagh
Thursday	11.30am - 2.30pm	St. Pio's Café	St. Pio Centre, Galliagh
	4.45pm – 5.30pm	St Brigid's Youth Choir	St Brigid's Church, Carnhill
	6pm – 7pm	Divine Will Prayer Group	Kildare Room, Carnhill
	7pm – 8pm	Holy Hour for the Unborn	Our Lady's Chapel
	7.30pm - 8.30pm	Youth Prayer Group	St. Pio Centre, Galliagh
	8.15pm – 10pm	Be Still – Men's Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel
Friday	11.30am-12.30pm	Divine Mercy Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh
Saturday	12noon – 1pm	The God Club	Kildare Room, Carnhill

PARISH SCHEDULE**ST PATRICK'S CHURCH, PENNYBURN**

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 6.15pm; 9.45am
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 10am; Wednesday: 7pm
Confessions:	Wednesday: 6.15pm – 6.45pm; Saturday: 5.15pm – 6pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Wednesday: 10.30am – 4pm in the Emmaus Room
Baptisms:	Saturday: 4.30pm; Sunday: 1.30pm

ST BRIGID'S CHURCH, CARNHILL

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 5pm; 10.30am & 12.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 9.30am; Thursday: 7pm; Saturday: 11am
Confessions:	Thursday: 6.15pm – 6.45pm; Saturday after 11.00am Mass and 4pm - 4.45pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Daily: 8.00am – 8.00pm in St Carlo Acutis Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm

ST JOSEPH'S CHURCH, GALLIAGH

Sunday Mass:	11.00am; 12.30pm (<i>An tAifreann Naofa</i>); 6.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 11am; Tuesday: 7pm
Confessions:	Tuesday: 6.15pm – 6.45pm; Sunday: 5.30pm – 6.15pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Tuesday: 11.30am – 7.00pm in Our Lady's Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm

Parishes of Glendermott & Strathfoyle

Sunday 4th October 2026

Twenty-Seventh Sunday in Ordinary Time

*Staying close to the one
who tends the vineyard*

For the third Sunday in a row, the Gospel brings us back to the vineyard. Two weeks ago, the owner went out repeatedly to invite workers, generous to all who came. Last week, we met two sons and learned that a true "yes" to God is shown in what we do. This week, Jesus tells the story of tenants who were trusted with a vineyard and forgot it was never theirs.

Our first reading from Isaiah sets the scene with a love song. God digs the soil, clears the stones, plants the finest vines and builds a watchtower to protect them. He gives everything, and then waits, hoping for good fruit. In the Gospel, the owner's patience is remarkable. He sends servant after servant, and finally his own son. It is a picture of how far God is willing to go to reach us.

The tenants' mistake is one we can all make: treating what we have been given as if we own it. Our time, our talents, our families, our faith, even the earth itself are gifts entrusted to us. Fittingly, today would ordinarily be the feast of St Francis of Assisi, who saw all creation as God's gift and held nothing as his own.

This week, we might ask ourselves: what fruit is God hoping to find in my life? Perhaps patience at home, generosity with our time, care for someone in need, or simply more time given to prayer.

If that question feels daunting, St Paul offers comfort in our second reading. Don't be anxious, he says; bring everything to God in prayer, and the peace of God will guard your hearts. We are not asked to produce fruit on our own. We are asked to stay close to the One who tends the vineyard.

As October begins, the month of the Rosary, may Our Lady help us bear fruit for her Son.